IDSC 4101

Generative and Agentic AI for Business

A 2-credit upper-division course for business majors
No coding required · 7 weeks · Project-based

[Your Name] · Department of Information Systems · [Semester Year]

The Gap We're Filling

Business graduates are already using AI — but most lack the vocabulary, frameworks, and judgment to lead with it.

What they typically have:

- ✓ Experience using a chatbot interface
- ✗ Understanding of why AI behaves the way it does
- ✗ Ability to identify automation opportunities in a workflow
- ✗ Vocabulary to evaluate vendor claims or lead an AI initiative
- ✗ Awareness of responsible AI risks in business deployment

No top-10 business school currently offers a no-code agentic AI course combining conceptual depth + hands-on tool fluency for non-technical students.

What Makes This Course Different

Most AI courses for business

→ Prompt engineering focus
→ Lecture + case study only
→ No hands-on tool time
→ Ethics as a standalone week
→ One-shot final presentation

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→ Builder + ideation mindset
→ Build sprints every other week
→ No-code tools students keep using after class
→ Ethics woven in, not siloed
→ AI Innovation Showcase with external guests

The 7-Week Arc

Wk 1–2 Foundations + Personal AI	Wk 3–4 Team Workflows + Business Apps	Wk 5–6 Agentic AI + Product Thinking	Wk 7 Strategy, Ethics + Showcase
Personal productivity First contact with Gemini NotebookLM deep dive	Automating with Zapier / Make Business function applications Midterm exam	What is an agent? n8n + Voiceflow build sprint AI product ideation	AI strategy frameworks Responsible AI session Capstone pitches

Personal → Team → Agentic → Strategic

14 sessions · 3 Build Sprints · 4 Reflection Posts · Midterm + Final Exam · Team Capstone Pitch

Tools Students Use — No Coding Required

Conversational AI & Research

Google Gemini
NotebookLM
Google AI Studio

Weeks 1–3

No-Code Automation

Zapier / Make
Relevance AI

Weeks 3–5

Agentic AI Platforms

n8n
Voiceflow

Weeks 5–6

All platforms have free tiers sufficient for coursework. Tool categories are durable — specific platforms can be swapped as the landscape evolves.

Assessment: Hybrid Model

20%	**Reflection Posts ×4** Individual · 200–300 words · Bi-weekly Personal observations, not summaries
25%	**Midterm Exam** Take-home · Open-note · Case-based No coding — conceptual reasoning only
25%	**Final Exam** Take-home · Open-note · Integrative cases AI strategy, ethics, governance
25%	**AI Innovation Showcase** Team pitch (3–4 students) · No prototype required External guests rotate through — trade show format
10%	**Participation + Build Sprints** In-class builds: Week 3 (automation) + Week 5 (agent) Engagement, peer feedback, attendance

The AI Innovation Showcase

Trade show format · Week 7 · External guests invited

Teams of 3–4 identify a real business problem and design an AI-assisted solution using course tools.
No working prototype required — the pitch IS the deliverable.
External practitioners rotate through team stations, ask structured questions, and provide feedback.

Wk 4	→	Wk 5	→	Wk 6	→	Wk 7 S1	→	Wk 7 S2
Teams form + problem statement		Solution design sketch		Peer pitch practice + feedback		Slide deck submitted		AI Innovation Showcase

Rubric: Problem clarity · Solution design · Business value · Responsible AI awareness · Pitch quality

"The hardest part of any AI project is defining the problem and designing the solution clearly. That's exactly what this format tests — and what employers are hiring for."

Ready to Launch

- Full 7-week syllabus with session-level detail — complete
- Hybrid assessment model: 2 exams + capstone pitch + reflections
- No coding required — accessible to all business concentrations
- All tools have free student tiers; AI Studio coordinated with IT
- AI Innovation Showcase creates a high-visibility department event
- Fills a genuine whitespace: no comparable course in peer programs

Seeking department support to offer IDSC 4101 in [Semester Year].

Questions welcome — [Your Name] · [Email]